



Humanitarian aid for a devastated Gaza



HAITHAM IMAD/EPA-EFE/SHUTTERSTOCK

An aid truck drives through destroyed buildings in Rafah in the southern Gaza Strip on Tuesday after this week’s start of the ceasefire between Israel and Hamas. Thousands of such trucks have entered the enclave now that the fighting has stopped, but organized gangs have fired on convoys, leading to pitched battles. **Story, A10**

Health officials left with ‘chaos’ as HHS goes silent

BY DAN DIAMOND, LENA H. SUN, CAROLYN Y. JOHNSON AND MARK JOHNSON

No meetings of cancer researchers to discuss issuing new federal grants. No new scientific reports on lessons from fighting avian flu. Not even private briefings for congressional staffers who have questions about health agency operations.

Health officials and experts

Trump’s abrupt orders affect research grants, meetings, health updates

said this week they are reeling after the new Trump administration on Tuesday abruptly halted external communication at the Department of Health and Human Services and its agencies,

including the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention and the National Institutes of Health. The pause extends through Feb. 1, according to a memo obtained by The Washington Post. The Trump administration also issued a second order indefinitely halting the travel of HHS personnel, according to a second memo obtained by The Post.

The Trump administration Thursday defended the holds as a part of the presidential transition

and said it had provided flexibility for urgent communications.

“HHS has issued a pause on mass communications and public appearances that are not directly related to emergencies or critical to preserving health,” Stefanie Spear, an HHS spokesperson and longtime ally of Robert F. Kennedy Jr., President Donald Trump’s pick to run HHS, said in a statement. “This is a short pause to allow the new team to set up a

SEE HHS ON A15

NFL QBs today run for their livelihoods

Commanders’ Daniels is among those starring with their legs and arms

BY ADAM KILGORE

The evolution of the NFL’s most important position will be on vivid display Sunday. The four quarterbacks vying for the Super Bowl play different styles. Washington’s Jayden Daniels is an electric current; Philadelphia’s Jalen Hurts is a battering ram. Buffalo’s Josh Allen is a freight train; Kansas City’s Patrick Mahomes is a child scampering away with the remote control. They are united in how frequently and proficiently they test defenses with their ability to run.

In another era, the rookie Daniels might have considered himself a running quarterback. In the one he grew up in, ubiquity has made the term obsolete. Can a quarterback of his generation keep the ball and run with it

SEE QUARTERBACKS ON A16

Svrluga: Commanders, Kingsbury have found their comfort level. **D1**



VICTOR J. BLUE FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Law professor Katherine Franke’s remarks on Gaza protests prompted colleagues to complain.

A professor criticized Israeli students. It put her job at Columbia at risk.

BY HANNAH NATANSON

NEW YORK — Katherine Franke was one cross-walk away from Columbia Law School when she spotted the colleague who reported her.

It had been seven months since he and another professor accused Franke of harassing Israelis on campus, citing her public allegation that Israeli students bullied Palestinian classmates. More than half a year since the university opened a probe that could get her fired. Twenty weeks since then-Columbia President Minouche Shafik dis-

closed to Congress, and the American people, that Franke was under investigation.

And just four minutes since the 65-year-old tenured professor, winner of a Guggenheim Fellowship, exited the 116th Street subway station in the early-September sunshine, headed to her office. As she strode by the university gates, she skirted students shouting “Free, free Palestine,” urging peers and professors to skip the first day of class to protest what they called Columbia’s complicity in the Israel-Gaza war.

SEE PROFESSOR ON A8

Trump attempts ‘death blow’ to diversity efforts

ORDERS SHOCK EVEN FOES OF DEI PROGRAMS

Government is focus, but firms, colleges also targeted

BY JULIAN MARK, TAYLOR TELFORD AND SUSAN SVRLUGA

In the first 48 hours of his second term, President Donald Trump moved to eviscerate the surviving remnants of affirmative action, swiftly upending decades of policy — actions observers say are sure to touch every aspect of American life.

The newly signed executive orders to end “illegal discrimination” and restore “merit to government service” were so sweeping and aggressive that even conservative activists — ones who had been waging a multipronged attack to end diversity initiatives in the private and public sectors — were shocked by their scope and intensity.

“I can’t believe he’s going this

far,” said Dan Lennington, deputy counsel at the Wisconsin Institute for Law & Liberty, which for years has led a relentless legal campaign to invalidate diversity programs. “It still is sinking in, because I’m thinking of all the ways in which this affects the average American.”

The flurry of executive orders was meant to put a hard stop on diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI) programs throughout the federal government. The administration ordered U.S.-run diversity offices to close and scores of their workers to be put on admin-

SEE DEI ON A5

Johnson: Speaker is key to Trump’s goal to reshape Washington. **A4**

World Health Organization: Exit by U.S. could have big impact. **A14**

‘Sexual texts’ beset bid to issue Jan. 6 subpoena

Johnson aide warned of lawmakers’ messages to Cassidy Hutchinson

BY JACQUELINE ALEMANY

An aide to House Speaker Mike Johnson advised Republican colleagues against subpoenaing former White House aide Cassidy Hutchinson as part of their investigation into the Jan. 6, 2021, attack in an effort to prevent the release of sexually explicit texts that lawmakers sent

her, according to written correspondence reviewed by The Washington Post and a person familiar with the effort.

The aide intervened last June, citing concerns that a subpoena could expose the texts, according to the correspondence and the person, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to talk candidly about private conversations. Johnson revived the investigation this week as part of an effort by President Donald Trump and his allies to seek retribution against perceived political enemies, including those who investigated his role in the Capitol attack.

SEE JAN. 6 ON A2

What happened on Thursday

President Donald Trump signed an executive order that aims to ease regulation on cryptocurrency and create a national reserve of such tokens.

Trump ordered plans to be created to declassify files on the killings of President John F. Kennedy, Robert F. Kennedy and Martin Luther King Jr.

The Justice Department revoked jobs offered to young lawyers. **A5**

A federal judge blocked Trump’s order on birthright citizenship. **A6**

The White House ordered federal agencies to revise telework policies. **B1**

In struggle with Trump, a hush comes over D.C.

Bowser and others in city at mercy of federal power adopt muted strategy

BY JENNY GATHRIGHT AND MEAGAN FLYNN

D.C. sued on Tuesday to block President Donald Trump’s executive order ending birthright citizenship — but the city’s top officials don’t want to talk about it.

The 18 states and another city, San Francisco, that filed the initial federal lawsuit in Massachusetts on Tuesday all blasted out news releases or spoke with reporters about why they felt Trump’s executive order was an “extreme” violation of the Constitution and denied basic rights to U.S.-born children of undocumented immigrants.

By contrast, D.C. Attorney General Brian Schwalb (D),

whose office typically alerts its every major legal action, was the only one who made no public statement. Through a spokesperson, he declined to comment on the lawsuit. A spokesperson for D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) also did not respond to requests for comment, and she has made no public statement about it.

The silence from top D.C. officials exemplified their emerging strategy for dealing with Trump. D.C., unlike other cities, has limited home rule and is subject to vast amounts of federal control. The city’s vulnerability has created a kind of inverse relationship between Trump and its top officials: As Trump has grown more vocal in his threats, D.C. officials have grown more muted, seeking to avoid inflaming a conflict.

On Day 1 of the Trump presidency, in which Trump signed executive orders cracking down on immigration, recognizing only two sexes and pardoning those who stormed the U.S. Capitol

SEE BOWSER ON A6

IN THE NEWS

Treasure hunt Along the Chesapeake Bay shoreline, a nonprofit is on the lookout for fossils that date back 23 million years. **B1**

Oscars surprises, snubs Academy Awards voters shook things up with nominations for “A Complete Unknown,” “I’m Still Here,” “The Apprentice” and other films. **C1**

THE NATION The Hughes Fire continued to rage north of Los Angeles as additional blazes sparked amid another day of dangerously windy and dry conditions in Southern California. **A7**

THE WORLD Donald Trump and Vladimir Putin have both talked tough ahead of an expected call. **A11** An international prosecutor is seeking warrants for Taliban leaders over women’s rights. **A11**

THE ECONOMY These charts help explain why Americans are unhappy with the nation’s economy. **A12** The family that owns Purdue Pharma has agreed to increase payments to settle litigation over the opioid crisis, promising \$6.5 billion over 15 years. **A15**

THE REGION Maryland’s effort to raise wages for tipped workers could get a boost from Trump’s call to exempt tips from the income tax. **B1** An FBI agent is accused of sexually assaulting a third woman in his Montgomery County tattoo studio. **B6**

STYLE CNN is laying off about 200 employees as it shifts to a more digitally focused model, the network’s chief executive said. **C1** WEEKEND Interested in close encounters of the adorable kind? Try these local animal experiences.

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